PROSPER AWUNI

Senior IT Security Engineer | SIEM | SOAR | EDR | Vulnerability Management | Security Leadership

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) and Senior IT Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience managing Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR), and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) platforms across complex enterprise environments. I have a strong track record in monitoring and responding to security threats, conducting comprehensive vulnerability management programmes, managing perimeter security infrastructure including firewall, email and web security gateways, and mentoring junior security analysts. I am adept at translating technical security findings into clear, actionable guidance for stakeholders, and I bring proven experience across identity and access management, privileged access management, and incident response in line with industry frameworks including NIST and MITRE ATT&CK. I am looking to apply my technical depth and security leadership skills in a Senior IT Security Engineer role within a dynamic City of London environment on a hybrid working basis.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL), CrowdStrike NG-SIEM; alert rule engineering, detection tuning, automated playbook development and orchestration
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR/XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, EDR, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM); Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck; vulnerability scanning, risk scoring, remediation tracking and reporting
- **Perimeter and Network Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall; email and web security gateway management; Mimecast; network perimeter monitoring and policy management
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO); BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Endpoint Management:** Microsoft Intune, Mobile Device Management (MDM), Mobile Application Management (MAM); device compliance and configuration baseline management
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle; MITRE ATT&CK aligned threat hunting and detection engineering; full incident lifecycle from triage through post-incident review
- **Security Frameworks and Compliance:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting; SOAR automation and playbook engineering; detection alert development
- **Security Leadership:** Mentoring junior analysts, security awareness training, stakeholder reporting, incident coordination

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer – University of the Arts London (UAL) *March 2025 – Present*

- Monitor, investigate and respond to security threats across SIEM, SOAR and EDR/XDR platforms, including Microsoft Sentinel (KQL) and CrowdStrike Falcon, managing the full incident response lifecycle from initial detection through containment, eradication and post-incident review in line with NIST 800-61.
- Own the enterprise vulnerability management programme, conducting regular vulnerability scans using Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) and AppCheck, prioritising findings by risk and driving remediation in coordination with infrastructure and application teams.
- Manage perimeter and email security infrastructure, including Check Point Harmony firewall policy management, Mimecast email security gateway configuration and threat protection tuning, and web security controls to reduce the attack surface.
- Administer Azure Active Directory (Entra ID) identity security, including Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and role-based access control (RBAC) enforcement to prevent unauthorised access and

protect against identity-based threats.

- Manage BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce least-privilege principles, control and audit privileged account activity, and reduce the risk of insider threat and credential-based attack.
- Administer Microsoft Intune for Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), maintaining endpoint compliance, configuration baselines and security posture across all managed devices.
- Mentor and guide junior security analysts, providing technical coaching on incident investigation, detection engineering and security tooling, and developing standard operating procedures and runbooks to improve team capabilities.
- Develop PowerShell automation scripts and SOAR playbooks to streamline incident response, accelerate alert triage and reduce manual analyst workload, improving overall Security Operations Centre (SOC) efficiency.
- Drive continuous improvement in detection coverage by engineering and tuning SIEM detection rules aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, reducing false positives and improving signal quality for the security operations team.
- Maintain ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus compliance, contributing to internal audits, risk register management and security policy development.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity – University of the Arts London (UAL) *March 2022 – March 2025*

- Performed security event monitoring, alert triage and incident investigation across SIEM, EDR and email security platforms, escalating and coordinating the resolution of high-severity incidents in a timely manner.
- Administered Mimecast email security gateway, managing spam filtering, sandboxing, URL rewriting and threat intelligence feed integration to reduce phishing and malware exposure.
- Conducted vulnerability scans using Tenable.io and Nessus, assisted in risk prioritisation and worked with infrastructure teams to validate remediation of identified vulnerabilities.
- Managed identity and access management processes including user provisioning, de-provisioning, Conditional Access configuration and MFA roll-out across the 8,000-user estate.
- Supported the management of Microsoft Intune endpoint compliance policies, device onboarding and investigation of non-compliant endpoints to maintain a strong security posture.
- Delivered phishing simulation exercises and security awareness training using KnowBe4, improving staff identification of social engineering attempts and reducing susceptibility rates.
- Contributed to the development and maintenance of security policies, procedures and incident response playbooks in line with ISO 27001, CIS Controls and Cyber Essentials Plus requirements.
- Assisted with firewall policy reviews and perimeter security assessments, identifying rule anomalies and supporting the clean-up of legacy access controls.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure – HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) *February 2021 – March 2022*

- Delivered security, quality and infrastructure engineering for a Software as a Service (SaaS) and financial technology (FinTech) platform provider, managing endpoint protection, access controls and security monitoring across cloud and on-premises environments.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and worked with development and infrastructure teams to track and remediate identified risks, maintaining a risk register aligned to ISO 27001 controls.
- Managed Active Directory identity controls, group policies and least-privilege access management, supporting quarterly access reviews and privilege de-escalation exercises.
- Supported perimeter security management, including firewall policy reviews, VPN access controls and network monitoring to detect anomalous activity.
- Wrote PowerShell scripts to automate routine security and infrastructure tasks, improving operational consistency and reducing time spent on repetitive manual processes.
- Contributed to internal ISO 27001 audit preparation, security documentation and control gap analysis activities.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and maintained a mature SIEM detection engineering function using Microsoft Sentinel and advanced Kusto Query Language (KQL), aligning detection coverage to the MITRE ATT&CK framework and significantly improving alert quality and analyst investigation efficiency.
- Deployed and optimised CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) across an 8,000-user estate, delivering comprehensive endpoint visibility and reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR) to endpoint-based threats.

- Owned the enterprise vulnerability management programme incorporating Pentera BAS, Tenable.io and AppCheck, achieving and maintaining Cyber Essentials Plus certification and driving a measurable reduction in critical and high-severity open vulnerabilities.
- Managed a full Microsoft Defender suite deployment (Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Defender for Identity, Microsoft 365 Defender) for over 8,000 users, strengthening cross-platform threat detection and response capabilities.
- Designed and implemented SOAR automation playbooks and PowerShell integrations that automated alert enrichment, Indicator of Compromise (IOC) blocking and case management workflows, freeing analyst capacity for higher-value threat hunting and investigation.
- Mentored and developed junior security analysts, raising team capability in SIEM query writing, incident investigation and threat hunting methodologies, and contributing to an improved team-wide response time and incident closure rate.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)